

Kamal Joshi

Staff Software Engineer — Distributed Systems & Data Platform Engineering | Go | Java | AWS | Kubernetes

Austin, TX | Open to remote-friendly roles within the U.S. | Open to relocation for the right opportunity
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Software Engineer and Technical Leader with deep experience building distributed systems, cloud-native platform services, event-driven data pipelines, and APIs at scale. Proven track record delivering new services and features within large products — designing at the architecture level, leading small engineering teams through full delivery cycles, and owning production quality end-to-end. Deep in Go and Java, with hands-on experience across AWS, Kubernetes, CI/CD, and multi-region cloud infrastructure. Applies AI-assisted engineering workflows (Claude Code, Codex, GitHub Copilot) daily across the full SDLC to ship faster and maintain high quality.

CORE STRENGTHS

- **Distributed systems and cloud infrastructure:** Go, Java, gRPC, REST, microservices, event-driven architecture; AWS (Lambda, ECS, EKS, S3, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, Secrets Manager), Kubernetes, Terraform, CI/CD (Jenkins), Docker
- **High-level design and architecture:** cross-service API design, data pipeline architecture, multi-region failover design, service integration patterns; architecture reviews with technical leaders and architects
- **Technical leadership and delivery:** leading small teams from design through delivery within release cycles; partnering with product to drive customer impact; Developer Owned Quality mindset
- **Production quality and reliability:** multi-region HA rollout, staged deployments, DLQ recovery, deployment validation, monitoring and alerting, incident response
- **Mentoring and knowledge sharing:** early-in-career engineer mentoring via code review and design feedback; team knowledge-sharing forums; cross-team coordination across engineering, product, and operations
- **AI-assisted SDLC:** daily Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and Codex across implementation, testing, IaC, debugging, and design; pioneered team-wide AI tooling adoption; working familiarity with agentic tool patterns

EXPERIENCE

Cisco

Software Engineering Technical Leader

November 2025 - Present | Austin, TX

- Led high-level design and delivery of a real-time **push security events** capability using the open **CloudEvents** standard — delivering **alpha on schedule (Nov 2025)** while leading a team of three engineers through design, implementation, and production deployment.
- Designed multi-region failover architecture for an **API anomaly detection pipeline** spanning Kinesis Firehose, S3/Iceberg, EMR on EKS, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, and downstream delivery — reasoning through data flow, failure modes, and recovery paths across the full distributed stack.
- Drove cross-service **high-level design** for customer-selected Splunk and CloudEvents data formats across alerts, security events, integrations, and notifications services, coordinating with architects and technical leads across four platform services.
- Prevented data loss during a production incident by identifying a **300k+ message DLQ backlog**, quantifying impact across **15 orgs**, and executing full remediation within **5-10 minutes** — a Developer Owned Quality response under live production pressure.
- Resolved a customer-scale API failure by tracing **250+ appliance registration requests** through authentication and rate-limit enforcement, driving durable fixes around retry/backoff, token reuse, and service ownership.

- Drove integrations-svc production readiness across **sovereign and multi-region environments** by decomposing a high-risk rollout into staged changes with HA validation, monitoring, and rollback planning at each step.
- Diagnosed and fixed a third-party integration issue live during a prospective customer evaluation, helping restore confidence and **contributing to the customer's purchase decision**.

Senior Software Engineer

January 2021 - November 2025 | Austin, TX

- Grew into production ownership for backend platform services, partnering with product, engineering, and operations to turn ambiguous problems into implementation plans, delivery paths, and production support decisions.
- Implemented **metrics instrumentation** for Authorization Service and Integrations Service using **OpenTSDB** as the timeseries database, providing visibility into service health and throughput.
- Mentored early-in-career engineers through code review, design feedback, and hands-on guidance; initiated "Tip Talk Tue," a recurring team knowledge-sharing forum on engineering productivity and best practices.
- Integrated AI tooling (Claude Code, Copilot, Codex) into the full SDLC; pioneered team-wide GitHub Copilot adoption ahead of broader Cisco initiatives.

Randstad Technologies US at Cisco

Senior Software Developer

March 2015 - January 2021 | Dublin, OH

- Designed and implemented **Go-based gRPC and JSON/HTTP APIs** for a cloud-native data ingestion platform; contributed to automatic generation of protocol buffer specs from SQL schemas.
- Built API-driven authentication and authorization flows using OIDC, OAuth 2.0, and gRPC-Web; designed a type-assisted search feature for an Active Threat Analytics dashboard.
- Optimized query performance for large IP address ranges; contributed architectural improvements for caching, load balancing, and clustered deployments.
- Reduced **100+ OWASP-reported security warnings to zero** through secure coding, browser security headers, input sanitization, and server-side validation.

Earlier Engineering Experience

Cognizant, Oracle, Collabera | December 2007 - February 2015

- Delivered backend services, internal tools, and integration features across financial services, healthcare, insurance, and public-sector domains.
- Built a foundation in Java, REST APIs, service integrations, automation, testing, and maintainable engineering practices.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate
- AWS Certified Developer - Associate
- MongoDB Certified Java Developer M101J
- Google Cloud Platform Essentials

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology
Dharmsinh Desai University